Inwesol-
Coaches Training

Session 0

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Preliminary Call

Session Objectives: C.A.R.E

- **C – Contextualize their background**
  - Understand who they are, where they're coming from, and their life circumstances.
  - This helps build trust and sets the foundation for the self-discovery journey.

- **A – Assess key concerns**
  - Identify their current concern, be it career confusion, stress, or anything else.
  - Let them express freely without judgment or rushing to solutions.

- **R – Read readiness to change**
  - Notice how open and motivated they are to take action/make changes in their life.
  - Some clients are ready to act, some are still thinking- meet them where they are.

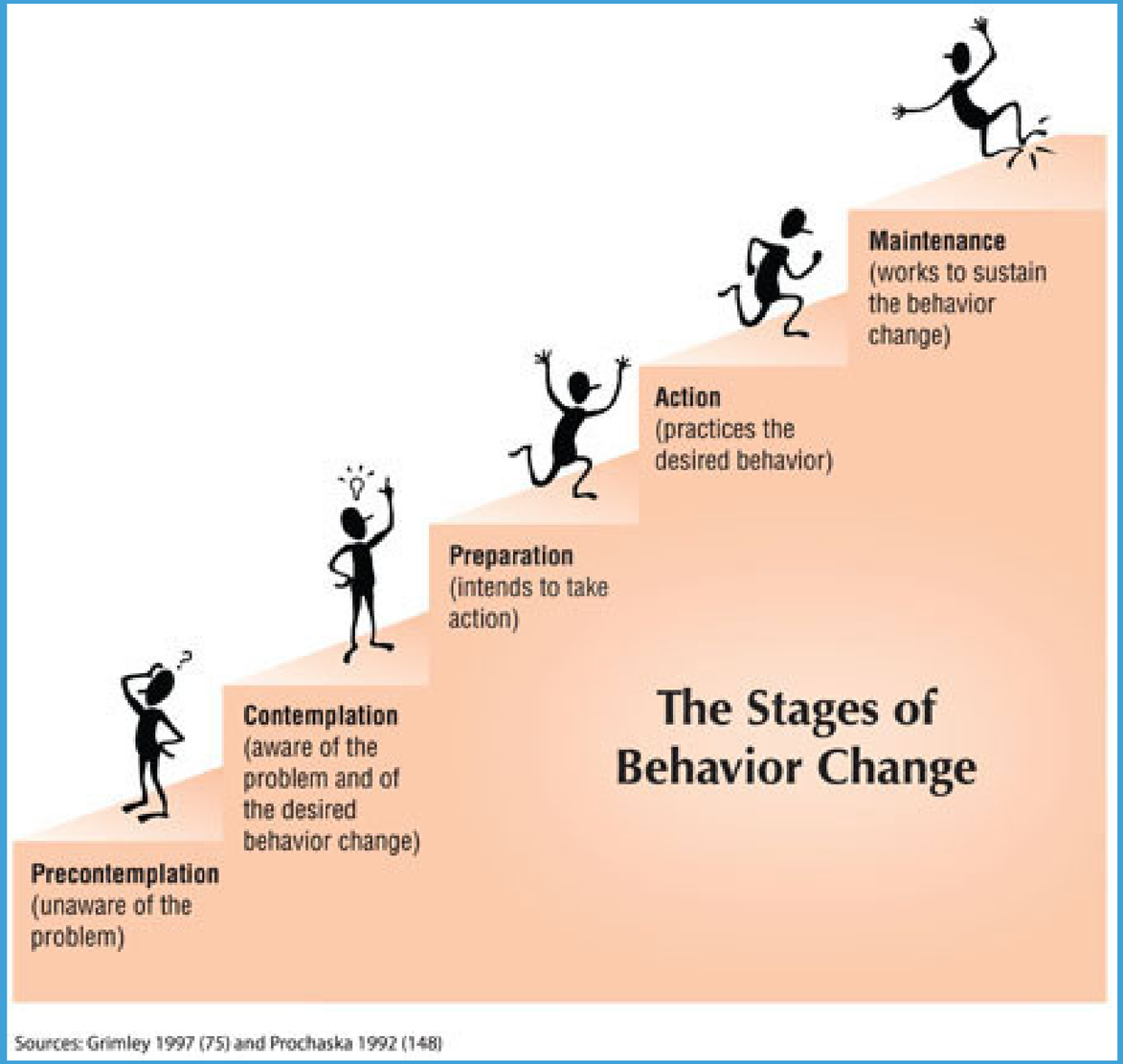
- **E – Evaluate need for professional help**
  - Be mindful of signs that suggest the client might benefit from therapy.
  - Knowing when to recommend professional support is responsible and ethical coaching.

Session Theme

Trans-theoretical Model

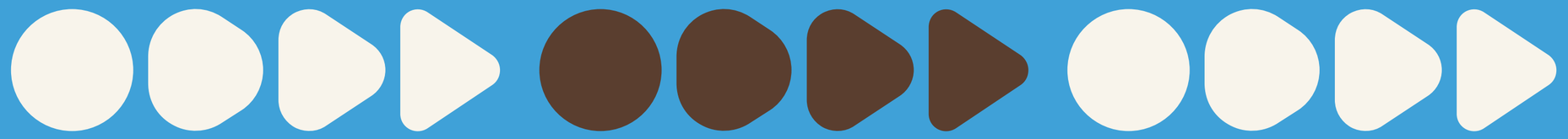
- Since this is the first session, the goal is to understand the client.
- The approach is simple: ask open questions, listen, help the client reflect and think deeply.
- Although this is the very first interaction with the client, helping them reflect (even in smaller ways) is important as this gives them the overview of how the coaching journey will look like. Therefore, encourage the client to think deeply about their situation.
- As another key objective of the session is to understand the client's readiness for change, learning about the Trans-theoretical Model (TTM) helps us understand how people move through stages of behavioral change.

Trans-theoretical Model



Trans-theoretical Model

The Transtheoretical Model (TTM) was developed by James Prochaska and Carlo DiClemente in the late 1970s. It was originally created to explain how people quit smoking, and is now widely used to understand and support behavior change in many areas.



Stages of Change

- **Precontemplation** – The person is not considering change yet, may not see a problem, or may be resistant.
- **Contemplation** – The person is thinking about change, aware of pros and cons, but still uncertain or ambivalent.
- **Preparation** – The person is getting ready, making small steps, planning, or setting goals to change.
- **Action** – The person is actively making changes, practicing new behaviors, and taking visible steps.
- **Maintenance** – The person is sustaining the change over time, preventing relapse, and building long-term habits.
- **Relapse** (sometimes included) – If old habits return, the person reflects, learns, and re-enters the cycle.

Questions for the session

Context

Before you proceed with the sessions, make sure to set the right expectations!

- Give an overview of what we mean by 'Self-discovery Journey'.
- **Explain what we DO:**
  - Increase their self-awareness,
  - Provide them resources career information,
  - Help them reflect via activities, assessments and
  - Collaboratively identify and set goals
- **Explain what we DON'T do**:
  - Share any direct advise,
  - Help them in job/course help (direct) and
  - Offer psychological counselling and therapy
- Explain how the session runs via the coach asking questions and the client reflecting.
- Set guidelines for asking questions without interrupting the client (hand raising).

Questions & Probes

Question 1. Tell me about yourself

- Probe: What does a typical day in your life look like?
- Probe: How have you made your decisions so far?
- Probe: Who do you spend the most time with at home or outside?
- Probe: What do you enjoy doing in your free time?

Question 2. Whats on your mind?

- What is the one thing that's bothering or exciting you right now?
- Probe: When you wake up or go to sleep, or even during the day, is there anything you often find yourself thinking about?
- Probe: People, pattern of behavior or project – check areas of problem
- Probe: and what else?

Questions & Probes

Question 3. Whats the real challenge here..FOR YOU

- Probe: In everything that you have shared, what's one thing you find hard to deal with?
- Probe: What is the one thing that is affecting you the most?
- Probe: and what else?

Question 4. What do YOU really want?

- Probe: What is it that you want as an outcome of solving this problem?
- Probe: What's something you wish would happen? Big or small.

Questions & Probes

Question 5. What are your key takeaways from this session?

- Probe: Was there anything that we discussed today that made you feel understood or helped you think differently?
- Probe: Did any question or topic today lead you to realize something new?

Assessments & Activities for Session-1

Assessments

1

- **Pre-Assessment:** This covers what we need to understand about the client before starting the journey. It covers the key areas that are often impacted by the distress the client is experiencing.
- Doing this at the start helps us understand the client's current state and doing it again at the end (Post-assessment) helps us see the progress and how much our intervention has helped.
- Right now, our pre-assessment includes, goal-setting, confidence, satisfaction etc. The list could also get updated periodically.

2

- **Career Maturity:** This test by Mark Savickas measures how ready an individual is to make informed and realistic career decisions. It looks at attitudes that influence career choices.
- The test helps individuals understand their preparedness, build clarity, and take steps toward making confident and well-planned career decisions.

Pre-Assessment Dimensions - Explained

Pre-Coaching Questions:

1. **Goal-Setting Theory (Locke & Latham, 1990)**
   - How clear are your current career goals? (1 = Not at all clear, 10 = Completely clear)
   - How confident are you that you will achieve your career goals? (1 = Not at all confident, 10 = Extremely confident)
2. **Self-Efficacy Theory (Bandura, 1977)**
   - How confident are you in your ability to overcome obstacles in your career? (1 = Not at all confident, 10 = Extremely confident)
3. **Cognitive-Behavioral Coaching (CBC)**
   - How would you rate your current level of stress related to work or personal life? (1 = Extremely high, 10 = Very low)
   - How well do you understand your own thought patterns and behaviors? (1 = Not at all, 10 = Completely)
4. **Work-Life Balance Models**
   - How satisfied are you with your current work-life balance? (1 = Not at all satisfied, 10 = Extremely satisfied)
5. **The Transtheoretical Model (Prochaska & DiClemente, 1983)**
   - How ready are you to make changes in your professional or personal life? (1 = Not at all ready, 10 = Completely ready)
6. **Positive Psychology Perspective:**
   - How much more do you feel that you are using your strengths in your career after coaching? (1 = Not at all, 10 = Completely)
7. **Life Satisfaction**
   - All things considered, how satisfied are you with your life as a whole these days? (1 = Completely dissatisfied , 10 = Completely Satisfied)

Career Maturity Dimensions - Explained

1. **Concern**: Refers to an individual's a**wareness of the importance of career planning and their orientation toward the future**. It reflects how much an individual thinks about, prepares for, and feels responsible for their career development. A high score on Concern indicates proactive engagement in planning for future career tasks.
2. **Curiosity**: Refers to how an individual **seeks information about themselves and the world of work**. It involves exploring career options, investigating job requirements, and reflecting on personal interests and values in relation to potential careers. A high score on Curiosity indicates active information-seeking and openness to new experiences.
3. **Confidence**: Refers to an individual's **belief in their ability to make and implement career decisions successfully**. It reflects self-assurance in overcoming obstacles, solving problems, and following through with career plans. A high score on Confidence indicates persistence in planning & executing career plans.
4. **Consultation**: Refers to the **willingness to seek and utilize advice from others**, such as parents, friends, teachers, or career counselors, during the career decision-making process. It reflects an individual's openness to external input and the value placed on collaborative decision-making. A high score on Consultation indicates a readiness to gather diverse perspectives and support.

Assessments

3

- **Well-being:** This assessment by Carol Ryff helps us understand the client's current state of well-being. If there are any areas they're particularly struggling in. The assessment includes sub-scales like autonomy, environmental mastery, personal growth, positive relationships, purpose and self-acceptance.

4

- **Strengths & Difficulties:** This assessment helps us understand the strengths of the client as well as areas of difficulties such as behavioural or adjustment challenges in various spheres of life. Although this assessment can be used as a screening tool and results can be transparently shared with the client, it is not a diagnostic tool.

Well-being Dimensions - Explained

1. **Autonomy:** Autonomy refers to the extent to which an individual experiences a sense of independence, self-determination, and resistance to social pressures. Individuals with a high score on Autonomy tend to be confident in their opinions, even when they differ from others, and are not overly concerned about the approval of others. Autonomy is helpful in understanding individuals' sense of internal control and self-reliance.
2. **Environmental Mastery: Environmental** Mastery refers to the extent to which an individual feels competent and is able to manage their environment and daily responsibilities effectively. Individuals with a high score on Environmental Mastery tend to feel in control of their surroundings, capable of creating living environments that suit their needs, and able to handle the demands of daily life. Environmental Mastery is helpful in understanding individuals' perceived ability to shape and manage their external world.
3. **Personal Growth:** Personal Growth refers to an individual's sense of continued development, openness to new experiences, and the feeling of realizing their potential over time. Individuals with high scores on Personal Growth tend to be open to embrace new challenges, and have a sense of improvement as a person. Personal Growth is helpful in understanding individuals' tendency towards continuous learning and self-improvement.

Well-being Dimensions - Explained

4. Positive Relations with Others: Positive Relations with Others refers to an individual's relationships with others, including the ability to form close, trusting relationships and the capacity for empathy and affection. Individuals with high scores on Positive Relations with Others tend to have satisfying and supportive relationships characterized by trust, warmth, and mutual understanding. Positive Relations with Others is helpful in understanding individuals' tendency towards maintaining healthy relationships.

5. **Purpose in Life:** Purpose in Life refers to the extent to which an individual has goals, a sense of direction, and a feeling that their life has meaning. Individuals with high scores on Purpose in Life tend to have a strong sense of purpose, a clear understanding of life goals, and a feeling that one's daily activities are meaningful and important. Purpose in Life is helpful in understanding individuals' sense of direction.

6. **Self-Acceptance:** Self-Acceptance refers to the degree to which individuals hold a positive attitude toward themselves, acknowledge both their strengths and weaknesses, and are satisfied with their past lives. Individuals with high scores on Self-Acceptance tend to have a positive view of oneself, acceptance of personal flaws, and satisfaction with one's life history. Self-Acceptance is helpful in understanding how individuals view and accept themselves.

Strengths & Difficulties - Explained

Developed by - Dr. Robert N. Goodman (1997), this measure is a mental health screening tool for use with children and adolescents.

It has 25 statements across 5 scales:

- Emotional symptoms,
- Conduct problems,
- Hyperactivity/inattention,
- Peer relationship problems, and
- Prosocial behaviour

It uses a 3-point response scale from 0 (not true) to 2 (certainly true).

Activities

1

- **My Career Story-1:** Our core belief is that every individual is unique and the hero of their own story. This aligns with Mark Savickas' Career Construction Theory, which also views career as a personal life story.
- In the very first activity '**My Career Story-1**', clients are asked questions about their current story, past career preferences, role models, and favorite stories.
- These reflections help us understand who they are as a person while also encouraging them to think more deeply about themselves.

- Note: All assessments and activities are sent to clients via pre-prepared links/forms through email.

Session Checklist

Before Session	During Session	Post Session	Other remarks
➢ If available, read about the client's primary concerns and background	➢ Build rapport ➢ Understand the background ➢ Understand the key concerns ➢ Identify readiness to change ➢ Provide an essence of coaching via reflection questions ➢ Set context & expectations for the coaching journey ➢ Discuss/explain the activities to be completed before session-1	➢ Share session summary ➢ Send reminders for scheduling the next session ➢ Send reminders for completing the activity	➢ Identify if the exhibits/shares issues that indicate a need for therapy

Next Steps...

- Note down any questions and queries you may have for the C3 Lab.
- Watch the session-0 recording of a real time client.
- Keep the questions for the session handy while watching the recording.
- Plan and facilitate the Preliminary session for a friend/family member.
- Record the session and reflect. Share it with Buddy Mentor for feedback.